

Case Summary

Problem Context

Operations managers like Jenny spend 30+ hours weekly on procurement firefighting--chasing invoices, preventing stockouts, managing supplier relationships reactively. This operational burden prevents strategic work and creates risk of production shutdowns, duplicate payments, and budget overruns.

Solution Approach

Build an autonomous procurement agent that monitors inventory levels, evaluates suppliers, generates purchase orders, reconciles invoices, and learns from outcomes--all without human intervention until approval stage.

Target Outcome

- 80% automation of procurement tasks
- Prevent 2+ stockout scenarios
- Catch 1+ invoice error
- Maintain 95%+ human approval rate on autonomous decisions
- Shift human focus from operational firefighting to strategic supplier relationships

Success Criteria

- Agent operates autonomously (makes decisions while humans sleep)
- Demonstrates multi-step reasoning: detect -> analyze -> decide -> act -> verify
- Maintains transparent decision trail for human review
- Learns from past decisions to improve supplier scoring
- Implements safeguards against catastrophically bad decisions